

100 Days of Linux - Day 075

Title: Secure File Transfer with scp

Today's Goal

Learn how to securely copy files and folders between Linux computers using the **scp** command.

Why This Matters

Developers, Data Engineers, Cloud Engineers and System Administrators regularly use scp to transfer scripts, configuration files, logs and datasets between local and remote machines.

Command of the Day

Syntax: scp [options] source destination

Common options: -r (copy directories), -P (remote port), -i (identity/private key).

Examples:

```
scp report.txt user@server:/home/user/
```

```
scp user@server:/home/user/data.csv .
```

```
scp -r project user@server:/home/user/
```

Beginner Lesson

The scp command copies files over an encrypted SSH connection. You can copy files from your computer to a remote Linux system or download files from a remote system to your current directory.

Practice Questions

1. Write the command to upload report.txt to a remote server.
2. Download data.csv from a remote server into the current directory.
3. Copy a folder named project using -r.
4. Use scp with a custom SSH port 2222.
5. Verify that the copied file exists using ls.

Hints

Remember the format username@hostname:path. Use -r for directories and -P for custom ports.

Mini Challenge

Create a folder named backup, imagine copying it to a remote server with scp -r, then list the local folder using ls.

Common Mistakes

Using lowercase -p instead of uppercase -P for the port, forgetting -r for folders, or typing the remote path incorrectly.

Did You Know?

scp uses SSH encryption, so your files are protected while travelling across the network.

Pro Tip

Test your SSH connection first before using scp to avoid transfer errors.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: scp report.txt user@server:/home/user/

Q2: scp user@server:/home/user/data.csv .

Q3: scp -r project user@server:/home/user/

Q4: scp -P 2222 report.txt user@server:/home/user/

Q5: ls

Homework

Write three different scp commands: one for uploading a file, one for downloading a file and one for copying a directory.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you will learn the ip command to view and manage network information.